



TWI MEDICAL GLOSSARY

for **CLINICAL STUDENTS & HEALTH WORKERS**

A Collection of Commonly Used Medical Words
and Phrases in Twi and English



MEPI - KNUST

TWI MEDICAL GLOSSARY

NAMES OF SOME DISEASES AND CLINICAL TERMS IN TWI

(NYAREWA NE AYARESABEA NSEMFUA BINOM DIN WO TWI KASA MU)



KWAME NKUMAH UNIVERSITY
OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY



KOMFO ANOKYE
TEACHING HOSPITAL



UNIVERSITY OF
MICHIGAN

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Two Medical Glossary

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FOREWORD

Language barrier negatively affects patient-clinician communication. One of the sources of confidentiality breaches in medical practice is through the use of untrained interpreters during medical consultations. Where confidentiality cannot be assured, patients will often keep valuable information from their health care providers. This is true when the medical condition of the patient may be associated with stigmatization, such as HIV/AIDS. The glossary aims to reduce the dependence of non speaking Twi health workers on interpreters and thus contribute to building patients' trust.

The development of the glossary was motivated by the need to tackle the language barrier faced by clinical providers at the Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH), Kumasi, Ghana who have limited or no knowledge of the Twi language. These include doctors, nurses, and local and international health researchers.

Over the years the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology's School of Medical Sciences has been enrolling an increasing number of foreign students, and Ghanaian students who are not conversant with the Twi language. There is therefore the need for a resource to assist these students to learn "medical Twi".

This Twi medical glossary is a compilation of common words and phrases encountered in clinical practice. It is meant to serve as a quick reference document only and is far from being comprehensive. The booklet presents a glossary of medical terms in both Twi and English, and includes words, phrases, and common expressions. It covers the major medical disciplines namely Internal Medicine, Surgery, Paediatrics, Obstetrics/ Gynaecology, and Dentistry.

The methodology used in compiling the glossary comprised: i) consultations with known experts of the Twi language, ii) interviews with selected medical practitioners, and iii) references to available literature.

It is expected that this booklet will be used by students (both foreign and local), clinicians and researchers. User feedback will be invaluable future editions. It is anticipated that interest in developing similar glossaries in other Ghanaian languages will also be stimulated.

PROFESSOR PETER DONKOR

Principal Investigator

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Acknowledgements	iii
Foreword	v
Table of Contents	vii
Introduction	xi
 THE HUMAN BODY - NNIPADUA AKWAA NO NKYEREMU	1
TWI ➤ ENGLISH.	1
Ɔbaa Nnipadua Anim – Front View of a Female	2
Barima Nnipadua No Akwaa - Front View of a Male	5
 NAMES OF SOME MEDICAL CONDITIONS IN TWI - NYAREWA BINOM WO TWI KASA MU	8
TWI ➤ ENGLISH.	8
 SOME COMMON MEDICAL EXPRESSIONS	18
TWI ➤ ENGLISH.	18
AILMENTS ASSOCIATED WITH DIFFERENT PARTS OF THE BODY	25
TWI ➤ ENGLISH.	25
1. Tiyareɛ/ Tipaɛɛ – Headache	26
2. Ani – Eye.	26
3. Aso – Ear	27
4. Ɛse – Teeth	28
5. Menemu – Throat	29
6. Nsa – Hand	29
7. Abatire – Shoulder	30
8. Nofoɔ – Breast	30
9. Koko Yadeɛ – Chest Pain.	30
10. Mfe – Rib	31
11. Funuma – Navel	31
12. Yafunu Yadeɛ – Abdominal Pains	31
13. Ahotutuo – Body Pains	32
14. Nan – Leg.	33

NNA MU YADEƎ - SEXUAL/ GYNAECOLOGICAL CONDITIONS	34
TWI » ENGLISH.	34
DeƎ Ǝfa ɔbarima ho - Concerning Men. . . .	35
Impotence	35
Concerning the Genital Organ	36
Expressions With The HIV/AIDS Virus	36
DeƎ Ǝfa ɔbaa ho - Concerning Women. . . .	36
Interaction Between A Doctor And A Patient	38
 GENERAL AILMENTS, FEVER AND COUGH	39
TWI » ENGLISH.	39
The Pediatric Emergency Unit	40
Fever Descriptions	42
Ewa – Cough	43
Bosome a Ǝwo Afe mu - Months in the Year	44
Nna a Ǝwo Nnawɔtwe mu - Days in the Week	44
 INDEX (TWI)	46
 NNIPADUA AKWAA NO NKYERƎMU - THE DIAGRAM OF THE HUMAN BODY.	54
ENGLISH » TWI.	54
Front View of a Female – ɔbaa Nnipadua Anim	55
Front View of a Male - Barima Nnipadua No Akwa	58
 NYAREWA BINOM WO TWI KASA MU .	62
ENGLISH » TWI.	62
 SOME COMMON MEDICAL EXPRESSIONS - NYAWERA BI A EWO NNIPADUA AKWAA AHODOɔ MU	72
 AILMENTS ASSOCIATED WITH DIFFERENT PARTS OF THE BODY - NYAWERA BI A EWO NNIPADUA AKWAA AHODOɔ MU	78
1. Headache – TiyaƎƎ/ TipaƎƎ	79
2. Eye – Ani	79

3. Ear – Aso	80
4. Teeth - Eṣe	80
5. Throat – Menemu	81
6. Hand – Nsa	82
7. Shoulder – Abatire	82
8. Breast – Nofoṣ	82
9. Chest Pain – Koko Yadeḗ	82
10. Rib – Mfe	83
11. Navel – Funuma	83
12. Abdominal Pains – Yafunu Yadeḗ	83
13. Body Pains – Ahotutuo	84
14. Leg – Nan	84

SEXUAL/ GYNAECOLOGICAL CONDITIONS - NNA MU YADEḗ	86
ENGLISH ➤➤ TWI	86
Concerning Men	87
Impotence	87
Concerning the Genital Organ	88
Expressions With the HIV/AIDS Virus	88
Concerning Women	88
Interaction Between a Doctor and a Patient	90

GENERAL AILMENTS, FEVER and COUGH	91
ENGLISH ➤➤ TWI	91
The Pediatric Emergency Unit	92
Fever Descriptions	94
Cough – Ewa	95
Months in the Year - Bosome a ewṓ Afe mu	96
Days of the Week - Nna a ewṓ Nnawṓtwe mu	96

INDEX (ENGLISH)	97
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INTRODUCTION

The College of Health Sciences in collaboration with The Department of Modern Languages, KNUST collaborated on this project to develop a Twi Medical glossary to remove the language barrier that impedes the dispensation of medical diagnoses.

Some patients go to the hospital not knowing how to express their ailments to the best understanding of Non-Twi speaking health practitioners, as well as others who are not well-versed in the Twi language. Some doctors resort to interpreters to enable them comprehend the complaints of their patients. Some patients also feel reluctant and uncomfortable disclosing their ailments in the presence of a third party.

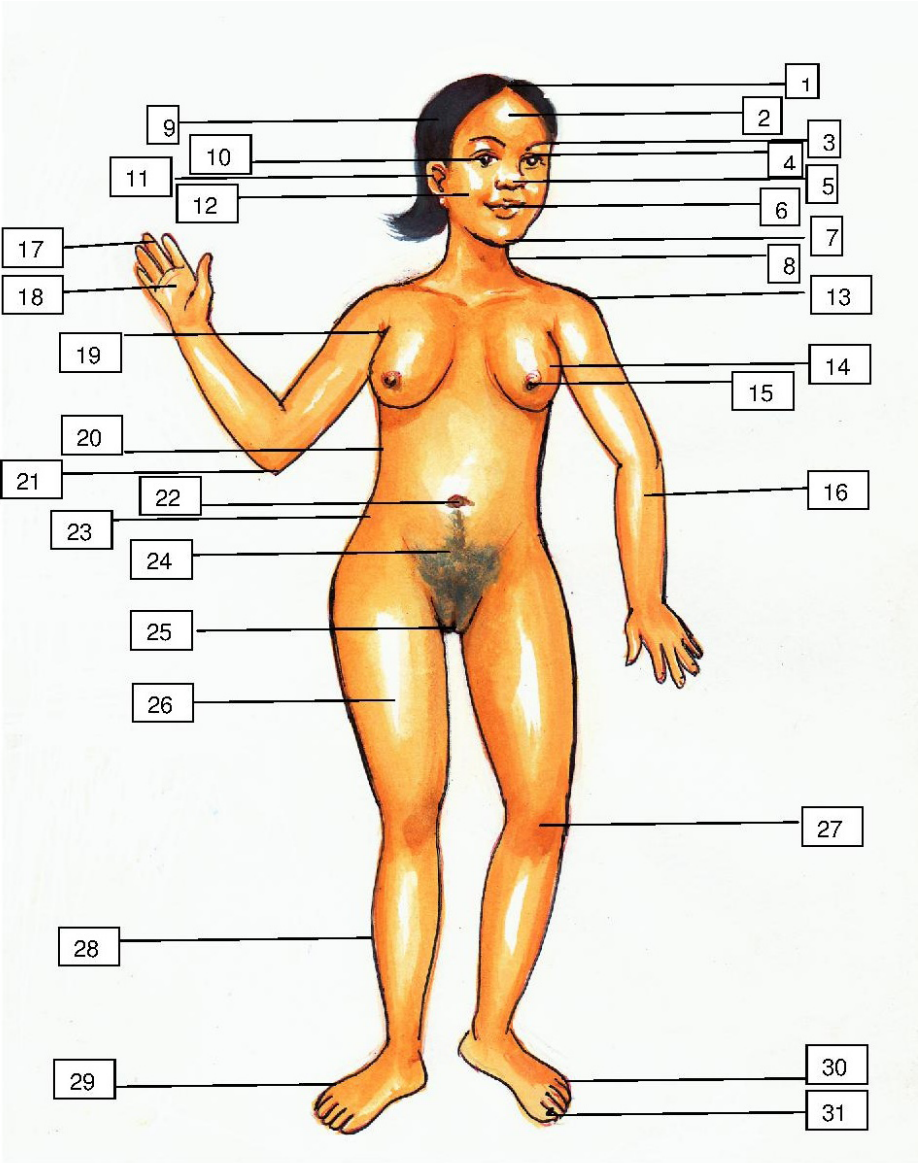
The scope of this work was to come out with some capture of the words and expressions that patients use but which practitioners find difficult to comprehend.

Some health practitioners from different departments in the Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH) Kumasi were selected for the interview. In some departments such as the Ear, Nose and Throat (ENT) and at the Accident and Emergency Unit, groups of doctors were interviewed together. A gynaecologist from the Manhyia Polyclinic in Kumasi was also interviewed to augment that of Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH).

NNIPADUA AKWAA NO NKYEREMU
THE DIAGRAM OF THE HUMAN BODY

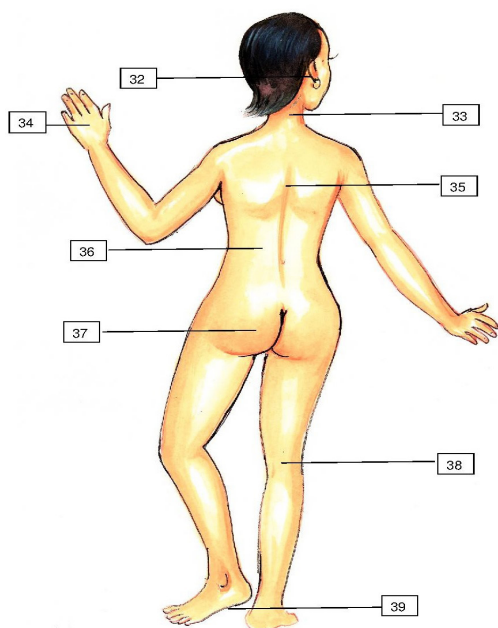
TWI >> ENGLISH

OBAA NNIPADUA ANIM – FRONT VIEW OF A FEMALE

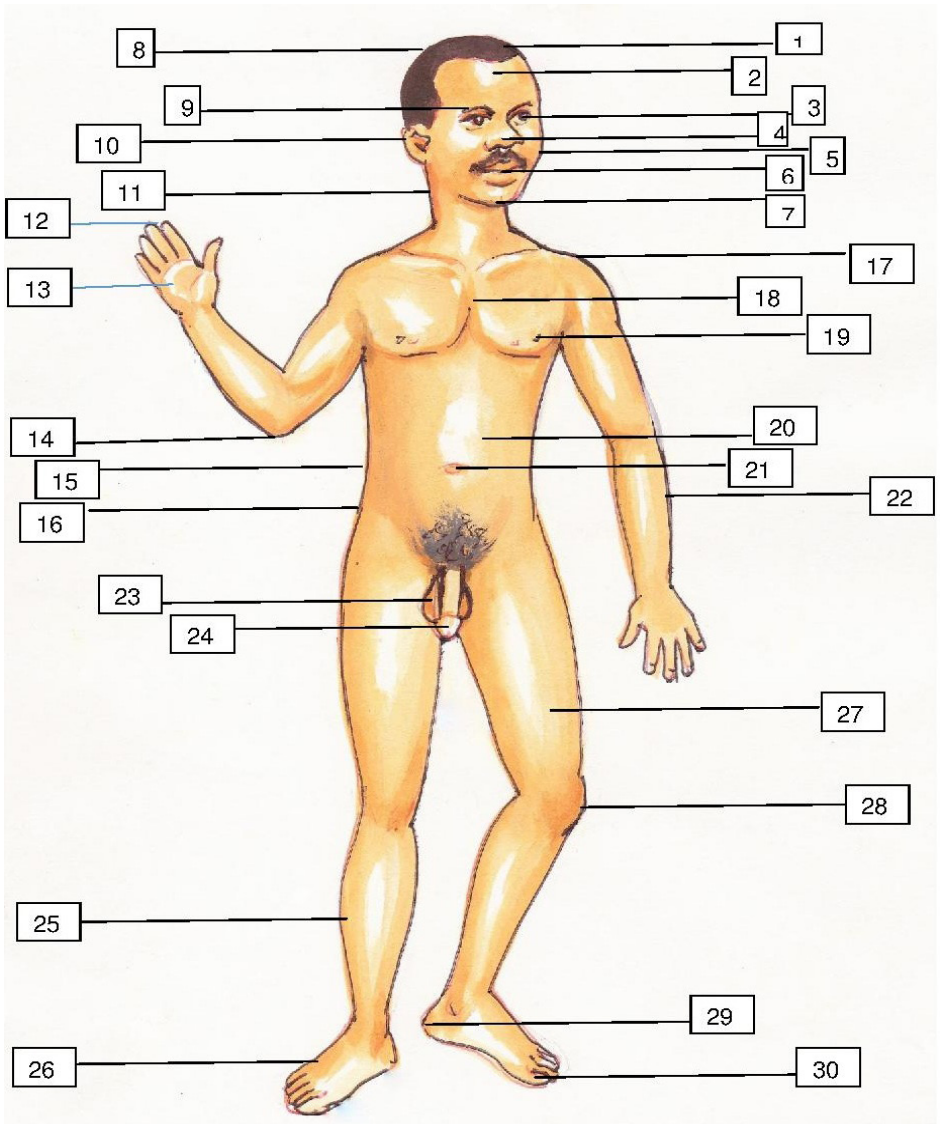


TWI	ENGLISH
1. Etire	Head
2. Momma	Fore head
3. Aniakyi nwi	Eyebrow
4. Aninton nwi	Eye lid
5. Hwene	Nose
6. Ano	Mouth
7. Abodwee	Chin
8. Ekɔn	Neck
9. Tirinwii	Hair
10. Ani	Eyes
11. Aso	Ear
12. Afono	Cheek
13. Batire	Shoulder
14. Nofɔɔ	Breast
15. Nofɔɔ ano	Nipple
16. Nsa	Hand
17. Nsateaa	Fingers
18. Nsayam	Palm
19. Mmotoam	Armpit
20. Mfe	Rib
21. Batwe	Elbow
22. Afuro	Stomach
23. Sisie	Waist
24. Asene/ Ayaasee	Abdomen
25. Etwɛ	Vagina
26. Srɛ	Thigh

TWI	ENGLISH
27. Kotodwe	Knee
28. Nan	Leg
29. Nammoromu/ Nantabono	Foot
30. Nansoa	Toe
31. Nan bowerɛ/ Mmɔwɛɛ	Toe nails
32. Asoakyi	Back of the ear
33. Kɔn akyi	Back of the neck
34. Nsaakyi	Back of Palm
35. Akyiri dompe	Back bone
36. Akyi	Back
37. Ɛtoɔ	Buttocks
38. Nantuo	Calf
39. Nan mmoromu	Arc of the foot

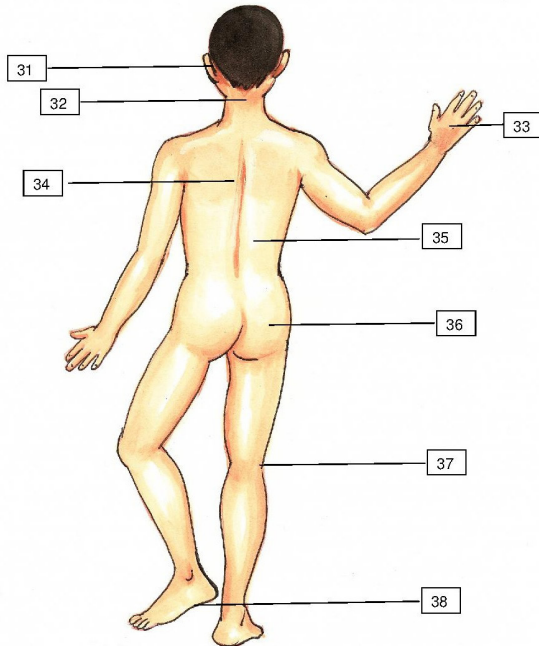


BARIMA NNIPADUA NO AKWA - FRONT VIEW OF A MALE



TWI	ENGLISH
1. Etire	Head
2. Moma	Forehead
3. Ani	Eye
4. Hwene	Nose
5. Afono	Cheek
6. Ano	Mouth
7. Abɔdwɛɛ	Chin
8. Tirinwii	Hair
9. Ani akyi nwi	Eyebrow
10. Aso	Ear
11. Ɛkɔn	Neck
12. Nsatea	Fingers
13. Nsayam	Palm
14. Batwɛ	Elbow
15. Mfe	Ribs
16. Sisie	Waist
17. Batire	Shoulder
18. Kokoɔ	Chest
19. Nofoɔ	Breast
20. Afuro	Stomach
21. Funuma	Navel
22. Nsa	Hand
23. Hwowa	Testicles
24. Kɔtɛɛ	Penis
25. Nan	Leg
26. Nammɔn/ nantabono	Foot

TWI	ENGLISH
27. Srɛ	Thigh
28. Kotodwe	Knee
29. Nampɔso	Ankle
30. Nansoaa	Toes
31. Aso akyi	Back of the ear
32. Ɛkɔn akyi	Back of the neck
33. Nsaakyi	Back of the hand
34. Akyiri dompe/ Bremɔɔ	Back bone
35. Akyi	Back
36. Ɛtoɔ	Buttocks
37. Nantuo	Calf
38. Nan mmoromu	Arc of the foot



NYAREWA BINOM WO TWI KASA MU
NAMES OF SOME MEDICAL CONDITIONS IN TWI

TWI >> ENGLISH



A

Abofono	– Nausea
Afikyikɔ mu yareɛ	– Menstrual disorder
Afeɛfeɛ	– Feverishness
Agyemmirekutu	– Mumps
Ahɔnɔn	– Rickets, Bow-legged
Ahaamu nsaa	– Perineal rash
Ahɔshene	– Irritation, itching
Ahɔshyee	– High temperature, Fever
Ahotutuo	– Body pains/ Sickle Cell Disease/Rheumatism
Ahonhono	– General Body swelling/ Anasarca
Ahwenepɔn	– Bleeding from the nose /Epistaxis
Akoma mu tokuro	– Hole in heart
Akomayareɛ	– Heart disease
Akyakya	– Hunch back
Akyiyareɛ	– Backache/Back Disorders
Amuntum	– Sleep paralysis
Ananse	– shingles
Ananse akye me	– Tingling sensation / Paraesthesia
Ananta	– Knock knees
Ani a ɛporo nsuo	– Watering / Tearing eye
Ani a ɛso yɛ wisiwisi/ Wantanworann	– Blurred vision
Ani a ɛtwa nkyene	– Eye discharge

A

Ani a εso yε tumm	– Dizziness/ Blurred vision
Anidane	– Menstrual pain
Anifira	– Blindness
Anikyew	– Squint
Anisobirie	– Dizziness/ Vertigo
Anumkankan	– Foul Breath/ Halitosis
Anumkuro	– Sore in the mouth
Apon	– Miscarriage
Aporɔporɔ	– Foot rot
Asabra	– Diarrhoea in a newborn
Asensen	– Tetanus / Tonic Seizure
Asikyireyareε	– Diabetes
Asofitie	– Ear discharge
Asoroben	– Migraine
Asosiyε	– Deafness
Asram	– New born illness
Asram Ntoosi	– Impetifo
Asram Punin	– Hydrocephalus
Asram Brodedwo	– Marasmus
Atiridii	– Malaria
Atiridinini	– Typhoid/ Severe Malaria
Ayamhyehyεε	– Panic/Anxiety
Ayamtim	– Constipation
Ayamtuo	– Diarrhoea/ Running Stomach
Ayamtuo brefoɔ	– Cholera

B

Babaso	– Gonorrhoea
Babasokraman/ Babasonini	– Syphilis
Babasoweremfoɔ	– HIV/AIDS
Bereboɔ mu kokoram	– Liver cancer
Bereboɔ mu yareɛ	– Liver Disease /Hepatitis
Bonini	– Barreness (on the part of a female)
Buropete	– Chicken pox

D

Dammo	– Madness
Dehyɛɛ	– Styel/Chalazion
Dompe mu kokoram	– Bone cancer
Dwoa	– Lump /Lymph Node Swelling
Dwonsɔkɛtɛso/ Dwonsɔkrobo	– Bedwetting
Dwonsɔmmogya	– Bloody urine (Haematuria)
Dwonsɔtwaa mu kokoram	– Bladder cancer
Dwonsɔyaayaa	– Pain in the genital organ when passing urine(Dysuria)

E

Ebunu	– Jaundice / Fever
Edwie	– Head/Body lice
Ekuro	– Sore / Ulcer
Etwere	– Fits/ Epilepsy

Ε

Εfeε	– Vomiting
Εfemfem	– Hypersensitive Feeling/ Tingling
Εhoa	– Dandruff
Εka me/ Εkeka me	– Colicky pain
Εkeka me	– Itching
Εkoro	– Pityriasis Vesicolor
Εnna mu yareε	– Sexually transmitted disease
Εpo	– Skin rash due to allergy /Urticaria
Εpon	– Miscarriage/ Seizure/Convulsion in children
Εte	– Cataract/ Leucorrhoea
Εhyehye me	– Burning sensation
Εse keka	– Loose tooth
Εtwo	– Hydrocele / Scrotal Swelling
Εwa	– Cough
Εwe me	– Gnawing pain
Εyam	– Ringworm

F

Funumatu – Umbilical Hernia

G

Gyepim – Elephantiasis

Gyemmirekutu – Mumps

H

Honam Kankan – Body odour

Honamyaa – General body pains

Huraaε/Ebunu – Jaundice/ Fever

Hwene mu a

εεεne nsuo – Running nose

Hwenemusie – Blocked Nose/ Catarrh /Nasal Congestion

K

Kεkεbo /Kεkεboyareε – Rectal Prolapse

Kεmpε – Goitre

Kεtewuie – Impotence

Kaka – Toothache/ Fungal Nail Infection

Kakagya – Fungal Nail Infection/ Paronychia

Kakawirewire – Tinea Capitis /Ring worm on the scalp

K - M

Kokoram	– Cancer
Konkoraa	– Bloody mucoid diarrhoea/ Dysentery
Kooko	– Piles / Haemorrhoids
Kramanyareε	– Rabies
Krawa	– Male Infertility
Krotoa,	– Asthma / COPD
Kwata	– Leprosy

M

Menemu kokoram	– Throat cancer
Menemukuro	– Sore throat
Mente pampan	– Anosmie
Mfa	– Guinea worm
Mfifirensaa/ Mfifisaa	– Heat rash
Mmɔboroɔ abo me	– Bee sting
Mmogyammosoɔ/ Mmogyaborosoɔ	– Hypertension
Mmubuo	– Paralysis, Polio
Mogyasoteε/ Mogyawee	– Anaemia
Mogyatuo	– Bleeding/ Haemorrhage
Mpɔmpɔ	– Boil / Abscess
Mpafe	– Pains in the ribs / Chest pain
Mum	– Dumbness
Muyareε	– Chest disease

N

Nkɔ̀nkɔ̀n	– Whooping cough
Nkonto	– Rickets, Bow-legged
Nketenkete	– Hunger in the night/hunger pangs/hypoglycaemia
Nkorɔ̀mo	– Snoring
Nkudaa	– Chronic Ulcer /Non-healing Ulcer
Nkwee	– Hernia
Nnwodwoɔ	– Stroke / Paralysis
Nofoɔ mu kokoram	– Breast cancer
Nsaa	– Rash
Nsaanini	– Pimples/Acne
Nsamanwa	– Tuberculosis
Nsonomuyaree	– Intestinal disease
Nsonkuronsuo	– Bedbugs
Ntenkyem	– Measles
Ntasuoakoram	– Pain in the throat when swallowing
Ntehyeewa	– Asthma
Nwaahono	– Cold sore/ Herpes labialis
Nyinsɛn a antɔ awodee mu	– Ectopic pregnancy
Nyinsɛn a asɛe	– Miscarriage
Nyinsɛn so bubuo	– Threatened Abortion
Nyinsɛn tuguo/ Nyinsɛn yiguo	– Abortion

O - T

O

Odeepua – Vaginal discharge /Candidiasis

P

Pampan – Odour

Papuu – Common cold

S

Sisiyareε – Waist pain

Sasaborɔ – Rheumatism

Saa mu yareε/
Sawa mu yareε – Kidney disease

Seporɔεε – Tooth decay/
Dental Caries

Somorɔ – Tick

T

Tipaeε – Headache

Tiyareε – Sinusitis/ Cold / Headache

Tiri mu dwie – Hair lice

Tirimukuro – Sinusitis

W

Wedeε mu kokoram – Skin cancer

Y

Yafunukeka – Abdominal pain

Yamkuro – Stomach ulcer

Yamtuo – Diarrhoea

Yarefufuo – Fever

SOME COMMON MEDICAL EXPRESSIONS

TWI >> ENGLISH

1. **Agyemmirekutu ayɛ me**
I have contracted mumps.
2. **Me ho ayɛ hye**
I have a fever.
3. **Me ho aben**
I have a fever.
4. **Me nan ahono**
My leg is swollen.
5. **Me nan ase ataetae**
My feet are swollen.
6. **M'afuru ahɛ / ahono**
Abdominal distention.
7. **Me ho yɛ me hene**
My body itches.
8. **Meyare akomayareɛ**
I have a heart disease.
9. **Meɔn ahwene**
I have nose bleeds/ Epistaxis.
10. **M'akyi yɛ me ya**
I have back pain/ache.
11. **M'ani so biri me**
I feel dizzy.

12. **M'ani nhunu adeε**
I cannot see.
13. **M'ani afira**
I am blind.
14. **Aporɔporɔ ayε me**
I have foot rot.
15. **Meyare asikyireyareε**
I am suffering from diabetes.
16. **M'aso fiti**
My ear discharges.
17. **Me yam hyehye me**
I am anxious / panicky.
18. **Ɔyε a na me yam ahye me**
I get panic attacks.
19. **Me yam atim**
I have constipation.
20. **Mentumi nnya me nan**
I cannot pass stool / constipation.
21. **Me yam tu**
I have diarrhoea/ running stomach.
22. **Babaso ayε me**
I have gonorrhoea.
23. **Mewɔ berεboɔ mu yareε**
I have hepatitis/ liver disease.
24. **Medwonsɔ mogya**
I pass bloody urine.
25. **Dwonsɔyaayaa ayε me**
I feel pain when passing urine.

26. Meyare ebunu

I have jaundice.

27. Ekuro ayε m'ano

I have lip ulcer / sore.

28. M'anom ayε kuro

I have sore mouth.

29. Meyare mogyaboroso

I am hypertensive.

30. aka me ba yi

My child has convulsion.

31. Me ba no asensen

My child has become stiff/ convulsion.

32. Me ba no bɔ nkɔnkɔn

My child has whooping cough.

33. Me ba no aso fiti

My child's ear discharges.

34. Me ba yi abɔ dam

My child is mad/ insane.

35. Me ba no ase ayε kuro

My child has genital ulcers.

36. Me ba no bɔ birimbirim

Startling attack.

37. Wei aka no

He/ she has convulsion.

38. Metwa

I have fit/ epilepsy.

39. ɔtwa

He/ she has fit.

40. **Dyare etwere**
He/ she has fit/ epilepsy.
41. **Me ti pae me**
My head is splitting.
42. **Etwo aye me**
I have hydrocele.
43. **Me hwoa aye kese**
I have scrotal swelling.
44. **Mebɔ wa**
I cough.
45. **Kooko asi m'ani so**
There is a growth on my eye.
46. **Kooko asi me to**
I have piles/ haemorrhoids.
47. **Me mogya so ate**
I am anaemic.
48. **Mogya retu me**
I am bleeding.
49. **Mehwa nkorɔmo**
I snore.
50. **Nkwee wɔ me so**
I have hernia.
51. **Nwaahono agu me**
I have sore lips.
52. **Me yam bobɔ mu**
Boborygmi sound.
53. **Mebɔ nsamanwa**
I have tuberculosis.

54. N'adwene mu ka no

He/ she is mad/ mental illness.

55. Ɔyare nofoɔ mu kokoram

She has breast cancer.

56. Me nyinsɛn a na ɛso abubu

Recurrent bleeding in pregnancy.

57. Ɔyare nantwiyareɛ

He/she has Anthrax.

58. Aso me tiri ne me kɔn

I have meningitis.

59. Mepɔn ahwene

I bleed from my nose.

60. Mapɔn

I have miscarried.

61. M'anidane aba

I am experiencing menstrual pain.

62. Me ho adane

I am pregnant.

63. Menyem

I am pregnant.

64. M'ase keka me

I have vaginal itch.

65. Ne ho nsuo agyene

Infertile male.

66. Dwoa atwe me /atwe me dwoa

I have lymph node swelling.

67. Mente me ba ne nka/Akwadaa no nka ne ho

No perception of foetal movement.

68. **Me ba no kəkɔbo abɛɛ ho**
He/she has rectal prolapse.
69. **Me home rete**
I am breathless.
70. **Nsuo regu me**
I have vaginal discharge.
71. **Afo de me**
I feel pressed (I feel like passing stool-used by some women to indicate they feel pressure to pass stool in labour).
72. **Me ho yera me**
I am irritable/ I feel uneasy.
73. **Ɛbre me kyem**
I feel like pushing (used in labour to indicate an urge to bear a child).
74. **Me ho dwane me/ me ho dwaa me**
I have burning sensation.
75. **Mayɛ hodwoo**
I am weak.
76. **M'ani gu so saa**
Insomnia.
77. **Mekɔ kwan so a.....**
Reference to sex/ When I have sex.
78. **Mete tɔɛɛ**
I fell down.
79. **Metwa hweɛɛ**
I collapsed/ I fainted.
80. **Kɔterekɔɔ asi me**
I have Hiccups.

81. Ntasuoakoram aye me

I feel pain in the throat when I swallow.

82. Amuntum akye me

I have sleep paralysis.

N.B: Literally, “meko kwan so “ means to travel but we use it in reference to sex.

**NYAWERA BI A EWƆ NNIPADUA AKWAA AHODOƆ MU
AILMENTS ASSOCIATED WITH DIFFERENT
PARTS OF THE BODY**

TWI >> ENGLISH



1. TIYAREΣ/ TIPAEΣ – HEADACHE

Me ti yε me ya	My head aches.
Me ti fa yε me ya	Half of my head aches.
Me ti fa dwa me	One sided headache.
Me ti mu keka me	My scalp itches.
Me ti dwa me gagaga	Throbbing/ Splitting headache.
Ne ti mu ka no	He/ She has mental illness.
Me ti mu hyehye me	I have burning sensation in my head.
Me ti pae me	My head aches.
M'adwene mu hyehye me	I have burning sensation in my head.
Me ti mu bɔn me	I have bad breath / halitosis.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Doctor: When did it start?
εhyεε aseε daben?

What treatment have you taken since it started?
εbae no aduro ben na woafa?

2. ANI – EYE

M'ani yε me ya	I have an eye problem/eye pain.
M'ani so keka me/ yε me hene	My eyes itch.
M'ani reporo nsuo	My eyes are tearing.
M'ani twa nkyene	I have discharge from my eyes.

M'ani so yɛ me kusuu

I have blurred vision.

M'ani so biri me/kyini me

I feel dizzy.

M'ani so ayɛ me bisibisi

My vision is blurred.

Biribi atɔ m'ani so

Foreign body in the eye.

Sɛ mehwɛ adeɛ a menhunu no yie

I cannot see clearly.

Mehunu adeɛ mmienɛ mmienɛ

Double vision / Diplopia.

Adeɛ wɔ akyiri a menhunu

I cannot see far.

Adeɛ bɛn me a menhunu

I cannot see objects close to me.

Kooko ayɛ m'ani

I have an eye problem.

Dehyɛ asi m'ani so

I have sty / chalazion.

M'ani so yɛ me wantann I have blurred
vision.

3. ASO – EAR

M'aso yɛ me ya I have ear ache.

M'aso fiti My ear discharges.

M'aso mu keka me My ear is itching/ itchy.

M'aso mu yɛ me kyee Noise in the ear / Tinnitus.

Biribi akohye

m'aso mu

Foreign body in my ear.

M'aso mu ye

me hene

My ears itches.

4. ɛSE- TEETH

Me se femfem me

I have sensitive tooth.

Me se ye me ya

My tooth is aching/
I have tooth ache.

Me se aye titiritii

My tooth has become numb.

Me se tutu me

I have severe toothache.

Me se so abu

I have a broken tooth.

Me se atu

I have lost a tooth.

Tokuro abeda

me se mu

I have a hole in my tooth.

Me se akyi nam

tu mogya

My gum bleeds.

Mepɛ sɛ mesi me se

I want to replace my missing tooth.

N'ano mae nsuo

He/she drools.

Kaka aye me se

I have toothache.

Mekasa a na nka wɔ m'anum/M'anum bɔn

I have bad breath/ Halitosis.

N'ano apae

He/she has a cleft/
split lip.

Tokuro wɔ n'anom

soro

He/she has a cleft palate.

Me se so aye fi

I have stains on my teeth.

N.B: In Akan, “ɛse” is used for both tooth and teeth.

5. MENEMU – THROAT

Me kɔn yɛ me ya	My neck is aching.
Me mene mu yɛ me ya	My throat is aching.
Me mene mu ayɛ kuro	I have a sore throat.
Me mene mu keka me	My throat is itchy.
Me mene mu yɛ me hene	My throat is itchy.
Mentumi mmene ntasuo	I have difficulty swallowing.
Kasɛɛ ahia me	I have swallowed a fish bone.
Wamene sika	He/She has swallowed a coin.
Mamene me se	I have swallowed my artificial tooth.
Me nne asi/ Me nne afam/ Me nne asesa	Hoarseness /change of voice.
Ntasuoakoram ayɛ me	I cannot swallow saliva /I have pains in the throat when swallowing.

6. NSA – HAND

Me nsa yɛ me ya	My hand aches.
Me nsa mu abu	My hand is injured/ broken.
Mada me nsa so	I have pain in my hand.

7. ABATIRE – SHOULDER

M'abatiri ahwan/ afrikyiri My shoulder is dislocated/ twisted.

M'abatiri yε me ya I have shoulder pain.

8. NOFOO – BREAST

Me nofo yε me ya I feel pain in my breast.

Edwoa abeto me nofo mu There is a lump in my breast.

Biribi da me nofo mu There is a lump in my breast.

Sε me ba no nom me nofo a, na εyε me ya I feel pains in my breast when my baby suckles.

Me nofo ayε kese My breast has enlarged.

Manya nofoo mu kokoram I have breast cancer.

Nsuo firi me nofo mu ba I have discharge from my breast.

Me nofo mu yε me duru My breast feels heavy.

9. KOKO YADEε – CHEST PAIN

Me koko yε me ya I have chest pain.

Me bo yε me ya I have chest pain.

M'akoma yε me ya I have Chest/ heart pain

M'akoma bo me paripari My heart beats fast/ palpitation.

Me mu yε me ya	I have chest pain.
Me sisi yε me ya	I have waist pain/ I have pain in my waist.
Me pa yε me ya	I have low back pain.
M'ayaase yε me ya	I have pain in my lower abdomen.

10. MFE – RIB

Mpafe asi me	I feel pain in my rib.
Me mfe yε me ya	I feel pain in my rib.

11. FUNUMA – NAVEL

Me funuma mu yε me ya	I feel pain in my navel
Me funuma mu keka me	I feel pain in the navel
Me funuma mu aye kuro	There is sore in my navel

12. YAFUNU YADEE – ABDOMINAL PAINS

Me yam tutu me	I have abdominal pain.
Me yam yε me ya	I have Abdominal Pain.
Me yam bobo mu / woro so	Borborygmi.
Me yam keka me	I have abdominal pain.
Me yafunu ka me dwee	I have colicky abdominal pain.

Me yam wowo me	I have prickly abdominal pain.
Me yafunu ahye kosoo	I feel some heaviness in my abdomen.
Me yafunu ahye	I feel bloated.
Me yam samforosamforo me	I have abdominal discomfort.
Me yam hwie	I have diarrhoea.
Megya me nan ntemntem	I have diarrhoea.
Biribi nenam me yam	Something is moving in my abdomen.
Me yam bon	My stool / flatus is offensive.
Meyi mframe a ebon	My flatus is offensive.
Meta a ebon	My flatus is offensive.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Doctor: Ehyee aseɛ dabɛn? When did it start?

Mperɛ sɛn? How often?

Eye a ahoro anaa mogya wo wo tiafi no mu?

Is the stool mucoid or bloody?

13. AHOTUTUO – BODY PAINS

Me ho ye me ya	I have body pain.
Me ho tutu me	I have body ache.
Me sasaboro aba/ M'ahotutuo aba	I have rheumatism/ Sickle cell disease.

14. NAN – LEG

Me nan ye me ya	My leg is aching.
Me nan ahono	My leg is swollen.
Me nan afrikyiri	I have a dislocated/twisted leg.
Me nan mu abu	My leg is injured/ broken.
Me nan mu tutu me	I feel pain in my leg.
Me kotodwe ye me ya	I have knee pain.

NNA MU YADEE -
SEXUAL/ GYNAECOLOGICAL CONDITIONS

TWI >> ENGLISH



DEƐ ƐFA ɔBARIMA HO - CONCERNING MEN

Me dwonso a na me barima mu yɛ me ya

I feel pain in my penis/manhood when passing urine.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS.

Ɛyɛ a nsuo firi wo barima mu ba?

Do you experience some discharge in your penis?

Wo ne ɔbaa daɛ nna sɛn nie?

When was the last time you had sex?

Woaware?

Are you married?

Wowo mpena?

Do you have any other sexual partner apart from your wife?

Wo ne ɔbaa foforo ada anaa?

Have you had any extra marital affair?

N.B: In Akan, “me barima” - my manhood is used instead of my penis.
To say, “me kote” - my penis is a verbal taboo.

IMPOTENCE

Me barima awu –

I am impotent.

Ɛmpagya/Me barima mpagya –

I don't have any erection.

Mentumi nkɔ kwan so –

I cannot perform sexually.

Mayɛ mmerɛ wo mpam –

I am sexually weak.

CONCERNING THE GENITAL ORGAN

Etwo aye me –

I have hydrocele.

Me hwoa mu ye me ya –

I have pain in my scrotum.

Me hwoa ho ye me hene –

I have an itchy scrotum.

EXPRESSIONS WITH THE HIV/AIDS VIRUS

“Babaso” is used for gonorrhoea but following the advent of AIDS, a new Akan terminology/name has been devised for AIDS. Some people call it “Babaso weremfoɔ” - the serious form/type of sexually transmitted disease. “Weremfoɔ” is used when something is considered to be serious or deadly. Others qualify it as:

AIDS Babso weremfoɔ - AIDS serious form of gonorrhoea

AIDS Kodawuo - The deadly AIDS

Using the AIDS alone is understood by all speakers of Akan. They say;

Wanya AIDS - He has contracted the AIDS

Wakɔtete AIDS - He has contracted AIDS

Here again, no distinction is made between the HIV/AIDS. All the states are called AIDS.

Syphilis is called Babaso Kraman - Dog gonorrhoea. Dog is used to qualify it because of the way the male dog likes sex.

DEE ɛFA ɔBAA HO - CONCERNING WOMEN

M'ase keka me/ M'ase ye me hene

My vagina itches/ irritates.

M'ase firi nsuo/Nsuo regu me

I have vaginal discharge.

Nka wɔ m'ase/M'ase bɔn

Offensive vaginal discharge.

M'ase ayɛ kuro

I have vaginal ulceration.

M'ase tutu me

I have vaginal pain.

Manya odeepua

I have candidiasis/vaginal discharge.

Mogya retu me

I am bleeding.

Mekɔ afikyire

I am in my menses.

Mabu me nsa

I am in my menses.

Mayɛ bra

I am in my menses.

ɛbɛyɛ bosome mmienu nie menkɔɔ afikyire

I have not had my menses for two months now.

Matwa bra

I am at menopause.

M'ayaase yɛ me ya

I feel pain in my lower abdomen.

Biribi abɛhyɛ/abɛfua m'ayaase

I feel a mass in my lower abdomen.

Biribi abɛhyɛ m'anan mu

I feel a mass in my vagina.

Me dwonsɔ mogya

I have blood in my urine.

INTERACTION BETWEEN A DOCTOR AND A PATIENT

DOCTOR

When did it start? **Ἐϋεε ασεε dabən?**

PATIENT I

Ἐϋεε ασεε Ἐdwoda no	It started on Monday.
Nnanu ne nne na Ἐϋεε ασεε	It started two days ago.
Nnansa ne nne	It started three days ago.
Nnenan ne nne	It started four days ago.
Nnanum ne nne	It started five days ago.
Nnansia ne nne	It started six days ago.
Nnawɔtwe nie	It started a week ago.
Ἐnnaanoo na Ἐϋεε ασεε	It started some days ago.
Nnawɔtwe mmienu nie	It started two weeks ago.
Dapən nie na Ἐϋεε ασεε	It started a week ago.
Ἐnora	It started yesterday.
Ἐne	It started today.

PATIENT II

Ὁρεπɔn bosome mu	It started in January.
Buronya akyi bosome baako	A month after Christmas.
Bosome nie	A month ago.
Bosome mmienu nie	Two months ago.
Bosome mmiensa nie	Three months ago.
Afe nie	A year now.
Mfee mmienu nie	Two years ago.
Mfee mmiensa nie	Three years ago.

GENERAL AILMENTS, FEVER AND COUGH

TWI >> ENGLISH



THE PEDIATRIC EMERGENCY UNIT

It is a unit that looks after the general ailments of children. These are some of the interactions patients have with doctors:

Me ba no home a ɛnsi so.

My child has difficulty in breathing.

Me ba no tee so.

My child is wheezing/difficulty in breathing.

Me ba no pene

My child is grunting.

Me ba no home ntɛmntɛm.

My child has fast breathing.

Me ba no bɔ birimbirim

My child has startling attacks.

N.B: In Akan, “me ba” is referred to both masculine and feminine ward unless it is qualified by “me babarima” - my male ward or “me babaa” - my female ward.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

DOCTOR

Ɔwo ntehyeewa?

Is he/she asthmatic?

ɛhyɛɛ aseɛ dabɛn?

When did it start?

Wadi mfee sɛn/Wadi sɛn?

How old is he/she?

PATIENT

Wadi bosome

He/she is a month old.

Wadi afe

He/she is one year old.

ɛsoro aka me ba no

My child has convulsion

Wei aka me ba no

My child has convulsion

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS.

Doc: Σε εβα α sen na ɔye?

How does he/she behave when it happens?

Parent: ɔsensene He/she becomes stiff.

Ne ho woso The body shakes.

Doc: N'ano pu/twa ahuro?

Does he/she foam?

Parent: Aane – Yes.

Daabi – No.

Doc: Mpen dodoɔ sen na yaree no ba?

How often?

Parent: Nnawɔtwe biara εba – Once a week.

Bosome biara εba – Once a month.

Yei ne deε edi kan – This is the first time.

Doc: Εbaεε no, εdeεn na woyεεε?

What did you do when it happened?

Parent: Me posaa gyeene de sɔɔ n'ani so.

– I dropped some juice from onion into his/her eyes.

Mebɔɔ no nsuo.

I poured some water on him/her.

N.B: In the Akan society, instead of a parent mentioning that the child has convulsion, she would rather say “wei” - (This) aka no - (has affected him/her).

“Wei aka no” is accompanied by pointing the right hand at the universe because convulsion “soro” literally meaning “the universe” is considered a verbal taboo in the ethnography of speaking in this respect. It is believed that if the expression: “εsoro aka me ba no” is used, the sickness will be increased hence the use of “wei” .

FEVER DESCRIPTIONS

39. **Ɛye a na me ho aye hye**
My temperature rises sometimes.
40. **Me ho aye hye**
I have fever.
41. **Me ho ye me hodwoo**
I feel weak.
42. **Me nante kakra bi a na mabre**
I have easy fatigability.
43. **M'apɔso m'apɔso ye me ya**
I have joint pain.
44. **M'anom ato**
I have lost appetite.
45. **Mentumi nnidi kɛse**
I cannot eat much.
46. **Me ti ye me ya**
I have headache.
47. **Me hwene mu firi nsuo**
I have runny nose.
48. **Ɛye a mefe/ Mefe**
I vomit / throw up.
49. **Aduane ka m'ano a na mafe**
I vomit or throw up after eating.
50. **Manyā kataa**
I have cold/catarrh.
51. **Manyā papuu**
I have cold.

52. **Manya yarefufuo/ebunu**

I have fever/ Jaundice.

53. **Me bo fono me**

I feel nauseous.

54. **Metete ntasuo**

I spit a lot.

55. **Me bo hyehye me**

I have heartburn.

56. **Mentumi nna**

I have insomnia.

57. **Mafoeε**

I am feeling feverish.

EWA – COUGH

1. **Mebo wa**

I cough.

2. **Obbo wa**

He/She coughs.

3. **Mebo wa a na mogya wo mu**

I have haemoptysis.

4. **Obbo nkɔnkɔn**

He/She has whooping cough.

5. **Mebo nsamanwa**

I have tuberculosis.

BOSOME A ΕΩΔ AFE MU - MONTHS IN THE YEAR

TWI

ENGLISH

Ορεπον	January
Οgyefuo	February
Obenim	March
Oforisuo	April
Kotonimma	May
Ayεwohomumo	June
Kitawonsa	July
Οsanaa	August
Εbo	September
Ahinime	October
Obubuo	November
Οpenemaa	December

NNA A ΕΩΔ NNAWOTWE MU - DAYS IN THE WEEK

TWI

ENGLISH

Εdwoada	Monday
Εbenada	Tuesday
Wukuada	Wednesday
Yawoada	Thursday
Efiada	Friday
Memeneda	Saturday
Kwasiada	Sunday

INDEX

A

Abɔdweɛ 3, 6

Aben 18

Abofono 9

Adane 22

Aduro 26

Afe 9, 38

Afeɛfeɛ 9

Afikyikɔ 9

Afira 19

Afono 3, 6

Afuro 3, 6

Agyemmirekutu 9, 18

Ahaamu 9

Ahinime 44

Ahɔnɔn 9

Ahoohene 9

Ahoohyɛ 9

Ahonhono 9

Ahono 18, 33

Ahotutuo 32

Ahuro 41

Ahwenepɔn 9

Ahyɛ 18, 32

Akoma 9, 30

Akomayareɛ 9, 18

Akyakya 9

Akyi 4, 6, 7, 18, 28, 38

Akyiri 27

Akyiri dompe 4, 7

Akyiyareɛ 9

Amuntum 9, 24

Ananse 9

Ananta 9

Ani 3, 6, 9, 10, 19, 21, 23, 26, 27, 41

Aniakyi 3

Anidane 10, 22

Anifira 10

Anikyew 10

Anintɔn 3

Anisobirie 10

Ano 3, 6, 20, 28, 41, 42

Anumkankan 10

Anumkuro 10

Apɔn 10

Aporɔporɔ 10, 19

Asabra 10

Asɛɛ 15

Ase 18, 20, 22, 26, 32, 36, 37, 38, 40

Asene 3

Asensen 10, 20

Asikyireyareɛ 10, 19

Aso 3, 6, 7, 19, 20, 27, 28

Asoakyi 4

Asofitie 10

Asoroben 10

Asosiyɛ 10

Asram 10

Ataetae 18

Atiridii 10

Atiridinini 10

Awodeɛ 15

Ауе 18, 19, 20, 21, 24, 27, 28, 29, 30,
31, 36, 37, 42

Ауамһеһеуе 10

Ауамтим 10

Ауамтуо 10

Ауеуоһомумо 44

B

Babaso 11, 19, 36

Babasokraman 11

Babasonini 11

Babasoweremfo 11

Batire 3, 6

Batwe 3, 6

Berebo 11

Bonini 11

Bosome 37, 38, 40, 41

Brodedwo 10

Brefo 10

Bubuo 15

Buropete 11

Bower 4

D

Daben 26, 32, 38, 40

Dammo 11

Dehye 11, 27

Dwie 16

Dwoa 11, 22, 30

Dwonsokrobo 11

Dwonsoketeso 11

Dwonsommogya 11

Dwonsotwaa 11

Dwonsyaayaa 11, 19

E

Ebunu 12, 13, 20, 43

Edwie 12

Efiada 44

Ekuro 12, 20

Etire 3, 6

Etwer 12

Ɛ

Ɛbo 44

Ɛbenada 44

Ɛdwoada 38, 44

Ɛfee 12

Ɛfemfem 12

Ɛhoa 12

Ɛhyehye me 12

Ɛka me 12

Ɛkeka me 12

Ɛkon 3, 4, 6, 7

Ɛkor 12

Ɛnna 12

Ɛpo 12

Ɛpon 12

Ɛporo 9

Ɛse keka 12

Ɛsone 13

Ɛsoro 12, 20, 40

Ɛte 12

Ɛtwe 3

Ɛtwa 9

Ɛtwo 12, 21, 36

Ɛwa 12

Ɛwe 12

Ɛyam 12

F

Femfem 12, 28

Funumatu 13

G

Gyemmirekutu 13

Gyepim 13

H

Hene 9, 18, 26, 28, 29, 36

Hodwoo 23, 42

Honam 13

Honamyaa 13

Huraɛ 13

Hwene 3, 6, 13, 42

Hwenemusie 13

Hwowa 6

Hye 9, 18, 42

Hyehye 12, 19, 26, 43

K

Kaka 13, 28

Kakagya 13

Kakawirewire 13

Kankan 13

Kitawonsa 44

Kokobo 13

Kokoboyareɛ 13

Kompɔ 13

Kokoram 11, 14, 15, 17, 22, 30

Konkoraa 14

Kooko 14, 21, 27

Kotodwe 4, 7

Kotonimma 44

Kramanyareɛ 14

Krawa 14

Krotoa 14

Koteɛ 6

Kotewuiɛ 13

Kwasiada 44

Kwata 14

M

Memeneda 44

Menemu 14

Menemukuro 14

Meyare 18, 19, 20

Mfe 3, 6, 38

Mfifirensaa 14

Mfifisaa 14

Mmɔborɔ 14

Mmogyaborosoɔ 14

Mmogyammorosoo 14

Mmoromu 4, 7

Mmɔtoam 3

Mmubuo 14

Mmɔwereɛ 4

Mogyasoteɛ 14

Mogyatuo 14

Mogyaweɛ 14

Momma 3

Mpafe 14, 31

Mpɔmpɔ 14

Mum 14

Muyareɛ 14

N

Nammoromu 4

Nan 4, 6, 7, 18, 19, 32, 33, 38

Nansoa 4

Nantabono 4

Nantuo 4, 7

Nketenkete 15

Nkɔnkɔn 15, 20, 43

Nkonto 15

Nkorɔmo 15, 21

Nkudaa 15

Nkwee 15, 21

Nkyene 9, 26

Nnansa 38

Nnanum 38

Nnawɔtwe 38, 41

Nnwodwoɔ 15

Nofoɔ 3, 6, 15

Nsa 3, 6, 29, 37, 38

Nsaa 9, 15

Nsaakyi 4, 7

Nsaanini 15

Nsamanwa 15, 21, 43

Nsateaa 3

Nsayam 3, 6

Nsonkuronsuo 15

Nsonomuyaree 15

Nsuo 9, 13, 22, 26, 28, 35, 37, 41, 42

Ntasuoakoram 15, 24, 29

Ntehyeewa 15, 40

Ntemntem 32, 40

Ntenkyem 15

Nwaahono 15, 21

Nwi 3, 6

Nyinsɛn 15, 22

O

Obenim 44

Obubuo 44

Odeepua 16

Oforisuo 44

ɔ

ɔgyefuo 44

ɔɛnɛmaa 44

ɔɛɛɔn 38, 44

ɔsanaa 44

ɔsensene 41

P

Pampan 14

Papuu 16, 42

S

Saa 16

Sasaborɔ 16, 32

Sawa 16

Seporɔɛ 16

Sisie 3, 6

Sisiyaree 16

Somorɔ 16

Sre 3, 7

T

Tipaee 16

Tiri 16, 22

Tirimukuro 16

Tirinwii 3, 6
Tiritii 28
Tiyareε 16
Tokuro 9
Tuguo 15
Tumm 10
Twa 9, 20, 26, 41

W

Wantann 27
Wantanworann 9
Wedεε 17
Wisiwisi 9
Wukuada 44

Y

Yafunukeka 17
Yamkuro 17
Yamtuo 17
Yareε 9, 11, 12, 16, 19, 41
Yarefufuo 17, 43
Yawoada 44
Yiguo 15

TWI MEDICAL GLOSSARY

NAMES OF SOME DISEASES AND
CLINICAL TERMS IN TWI

(NYAREWA NE AYARESABEA NSEMFOA BINOM DIN WO TWI KASA MU)

ENGLISH TO TWI

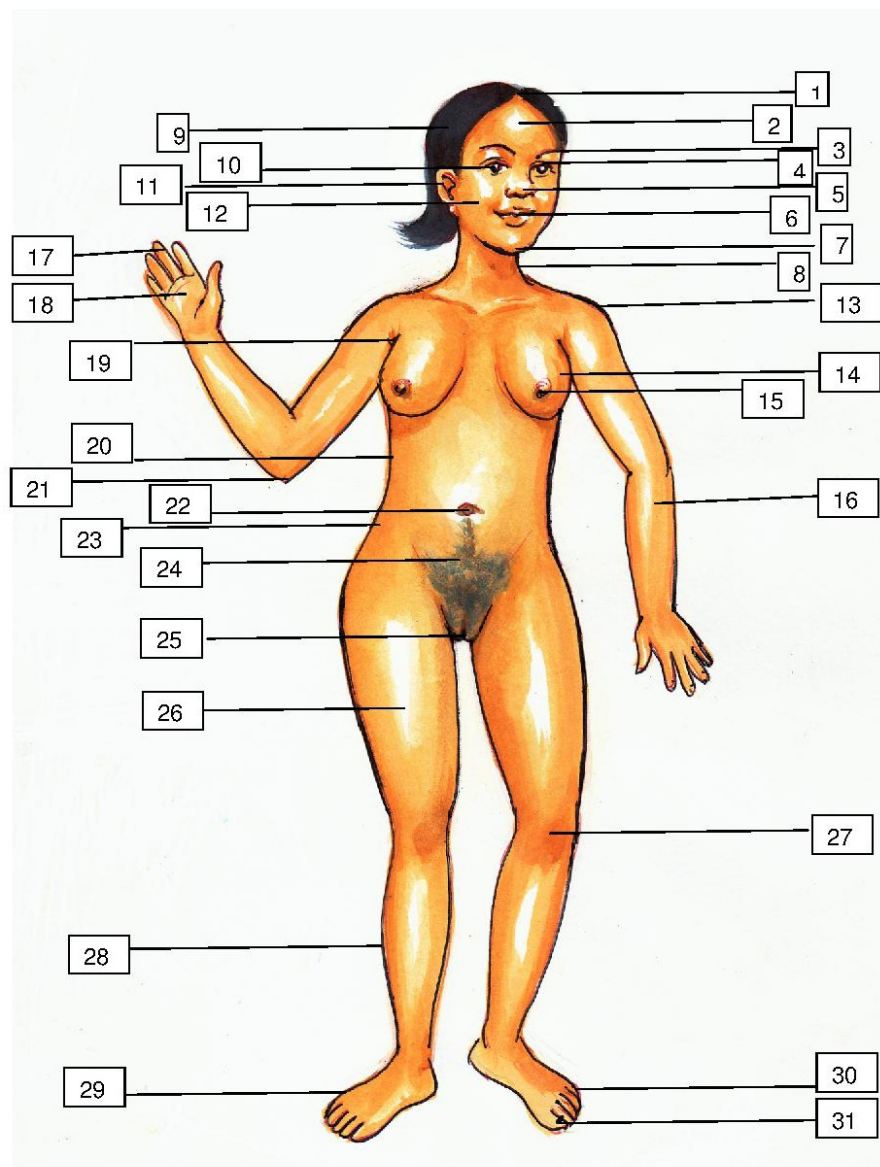


THE DIAGRAM OF THE HUMAN BODY -
NNIPADUA AKWAA NO NKYEREMU

ENGLISH >> TWI



FRONT VIEW OF A FEMALE – 3BAA NNIPADUA ANIM

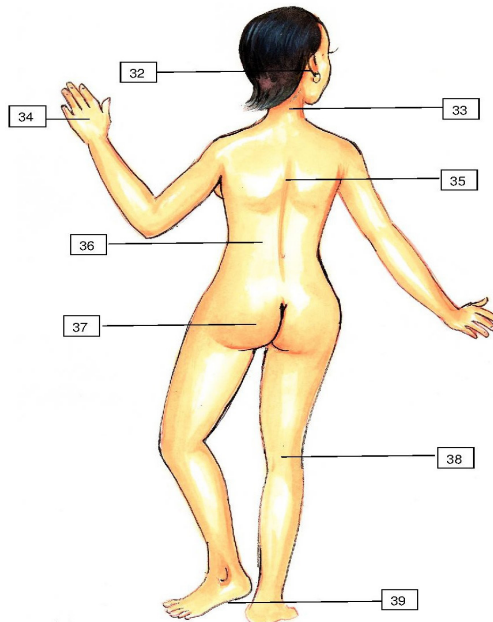


ENGLISH	TWI
1. Head	Etire
2. Forehead	Momma
3. Eyebrow	Aniakyi nwi
4. Eye lid	Aninton nwi
5. Nose	Hwene
6. Mouth	Ano
7. Chin	Abɔdwɛ
8. Neck	Ekɔn
9. Hair	Tirinwii
10. Eyes	Ani
11. Ear	Aso
12. Cheek	Afono
13. Shoulder	Batire
14. Breast	Nofoɔ
15. Nipple	Nofoɔ ano
16. Hand	Nsa
17. Fingers	Nsateaa
18. Palm	Nsayam
19. Armpit	Mmɔtoam
20. Rib	Mfe
21. Elbow	Batwɛ
22. Stomach	Afuro
23. Waist	Sisie
24. Abdomen	Asene/ Ayaaseɛ
25. Vagina	ɛtwɛ
26. Thigh	Srɛ

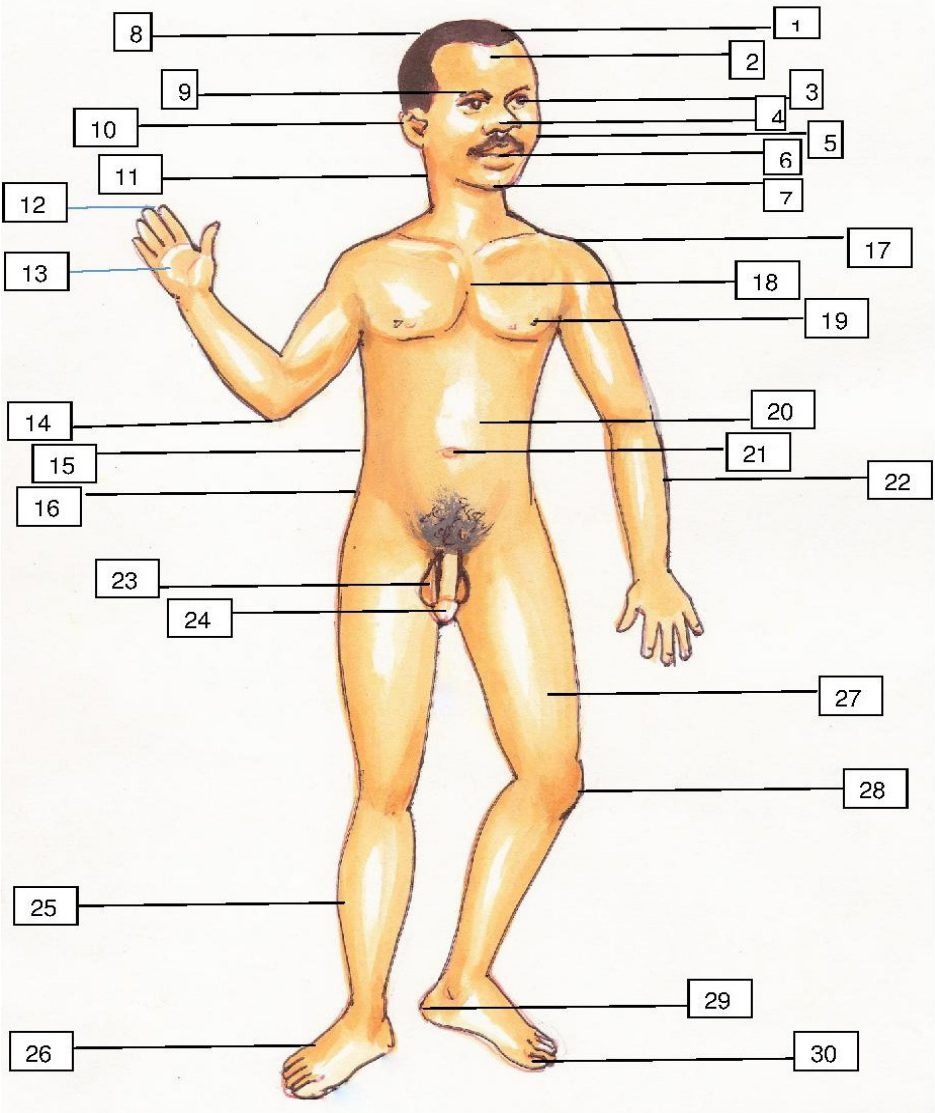
ENGLISH

TWI

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| 27. Knee | Kotodwe |
| 28. Leg | Nan |
| 29. Foot | Nammoromu/ Nantabono |
| 30. Toe | Nansoa |
| 31. Toe nails | Nan bɔwɛɛ/ Mmɔwɛɛ |
| 32. Back of the ear | Asoakyi |
| 33. Back of the neck | Kɔn akyi |
| 34. Back of Palm | Nsaakyi |
| 35. Back bone | Akyiri dompe |
| 36. Back | Akyi |
| 37. Buttocks | Ɛtoɔ |
| 38. Calf | Nantuo |
| 39. Arc of the foot | Nan mmoromu |



FRONT VIEW OF A MALE - BARIMA NNIPADUA NO AKWA

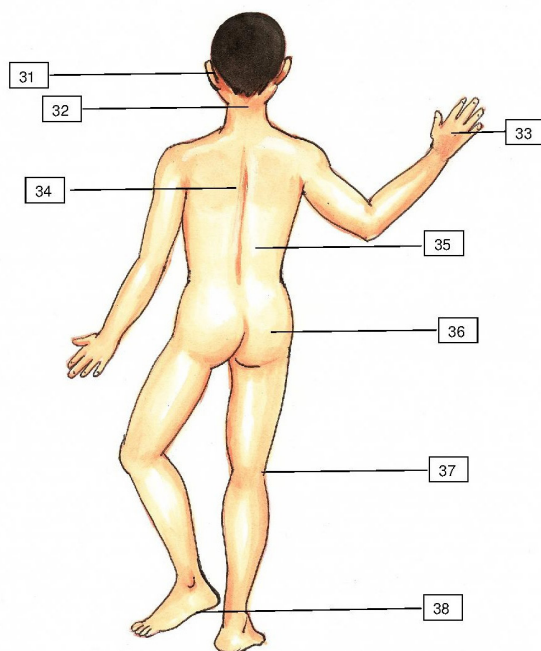


ENGLISH	TWI
1. Head	Etire
2. Forehead	Moma
3. Eye	Ani
4. Nose	Hwene
5. Cheek	Afono
6. Mouth	Ano
7. Chin	Abɔdwɛɛ
8. Hair	Tirinwii
9. Eyebrow	Ani akyi nwi
10. Ear	Aso
11. Neck	Ekɔn
12. Fingers	Nsatea
13. Palm	Nsayam
14. Elbow	Batwɛ
15. Ribs	Mfe
16. Waist	Sisie
17. Shoulder	Batire
18. Chest	Kokoɔ
19. Breast	Nofoɔ
20. Stomach	Afuro
21. Navel	Funuma
22. Hand	Nsa
23. Testicles	Hwowa
24. Penis	Kɔtɛɛ
25. Leg	Nan
26. Foot	Nammon/ nantabono

ENGLISH

TWI

27. Thigh	Srɛ
28. Knee	Kotodwe
29. Ankle	Nampɔso
30. Toes	Nansoaa
31. Back of the ear	Aso akyi
32. Back of the neck	Ekɔn akyi
33. Back of the hand	Nsaakyi
34. Back bone	Akyiri dompe/ Brɛmoɔ
35. Back	Akyi
36. Buttocks	Etɔɔ
37. Calf	Nantuo
38. Arc of the foot	Nan mmoromu



NAMES OF SOME MEDICAL CONDITIONS IN TWI

NYAREWA BINOM WO TWI KASA MU

ENGLISH ➤➤ TWI



A

Abdominal pain	–	Yafunukeka
AIDS/HIV	–	Babasoweremfoɔ
Anaemia	–	Mogyasoteɛ / Mogyawee
Asthma	–	Ntehyeewa

B

Backache/ Back Disorders	–	Akyiyadeɛ
Barreness (on the part of a female)– (on the part of a man) –		Bonini Krawa
Bedwetting	–	Dwonsɔkɛtɛso
Bleeding	–	Mmogyatuo
Bleeding from the nose/ Epistaxis	–	Ahwenepɔn
Blindness	–	Anifira
Blurred vision	–	Ani a ɛso yɛ wisiwisi/ Ani a ɛso yɛ tummm / Ani a ɛso yɛ wantanworann
Bloody urine (Haematuria)	–	Dwonsɔmmogya
Bloody mucoid diarrhoea/ Dysentery	–	Konkoraa
Body odour	–	Honam kankan
Body swelling/ Anasarca	–	Ahonhono

B - C

Boil /Abscess	– Mpɔmpɔ
Bone cancer	– Dompe mu kokoram
Brain Tumor	– Mpɔmpɔ a ɛto adwene mu
Breast cancer	– Nofoɔ mu kokoram

C

Catarrh/ Blocked Nose/ Nasal Congestion	Hwenemusie
Cancer	– Kokoram
Candidiasis/ Vaginal discharge	– Odeepua
Chalazion / Styne	– Dehyɛ
Chronic Ulcer/ Non-healing Ulcer	– Nkudaa
Chicken pox	– Buropete
Cholera	– Ayamtuɔ brɛfoɔ
Cold sore/	
Herpes labialis	– Nwaahono
Common cold	– Papuu
Constipation	– Ayamtim
Convulsion	– ɛsoro ka no
Cough	– ɛwa

D

Dandruff	–	ᲙᲗᲐᲗ
Deafness	–	Asosie/Asosiye
Dental Caries/ Tooth decay	–	Seporɔɛɛ
Diabetes	–	Asikyireyadeɛ
Diarrhoea/		
Running stomach	–	Ayamtuo
Diarrhoea in a newborn	–	Asabra
Diphtheria	–	Ahrawa mu yaree
Dizziness	–	Anisobire/ Ani a ɛso yɛ tumm
Dumbness	–	Mum
Dysentery/ Bloody mucoid diarrhoea	–	Konkoraa

E

Ear discharge	–	Asofitie
Ectopic Pregnancy	–	Nyinsɛn a antɔ awodeɛ mu
Elephantiasis	–	Gyepim
Epilepsy/ Fits	–	Etwerɛ

F

Fever/ High Temperature	–	Ahoɔhyɛɛ
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F - H

Fit/ Epilepsy	–	Etwere
Foot rot	–	Aporɔporɔ
Foul Breath/ Halitosis	–	Anum Kankan
Fungal Nail Infection/ Paronychia	–	Kakagya

G

Gonorrhoea	–	Babaso
Goiter	–	Kɔmpɔ
Guinea worm	–	Mfa
General body pains	–	Honamyaa

H

Haemorrhage/ Bleeding	–	Mmogyatuo
Hair lice	–	Tiri mu dwie
Halitosis/ Foul Breath	–	Anum Kankan
Headache	–	Tipaee
Heat rash	–	Mfifirensaa
Hepatitis/ Liver Disease	–	Bereboɔ mu yaree
Herpes labialis/ Cold sore	–	Nwaahono
High temperature/ Fever	–	Ahochyee

Hole in heart	– Akoma mu tokuro
Hunchback	– Akyakya
Hunger in the night/ Hypoglycaemia/ Hunger pangs	– Nketenkete
Hypertension	– Mmogyammorosoo

I

Impotence	– Kotewuiε
Intestinal disease	– Nsonomuyadeε
Irritation, Itching	– Ahoohene

J

Jaundice/ Fever	– Ebunu/huraεε/yarefufuo
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K

Kidney disease	– Saa mu yareε/ Sawa mu yareε
Knocking knees	– Ananta

L

Leprosy	– Kwata
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M.....

N

P

Pain in the genital organ (Dysuria)	- Dwonsayaaya
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Pain in the ribs/ Chest pain	– Mpafe
Pain in the throat when swallowing	– Ntasuoakoram
Paralysis, Polio	– Mmubuo
Perineal rash	– Ahaamu nsaa
Piles/ Haemorrhoids	– Kooko
Pimples/ Acne	– Nsaanini
Pityriasis Vesicolor	– Ekoro
Prostrate cancer	– Dwonsotwaa mu kokoram

R

Rabies	– Kramanyaree
Rash	– Nsaa
Rectal Prolapse	– Kokoboyaree
Rheumatism	– Sasaboro
Ringworm	– Eyam
Ring worm on the scalp/ Tinea Capitis	– Kakawirewire
Running nose	– Hwene mu a esone nsuo
Running stomach/ Diarrhoea	– Ayamtuo

S

Shingles	– Ananse
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S - T

Sore in the mouth	– Anumkuro
Stye / Chalazion	– Dehyeε
Syphilis	– Babasokraman
Sore/ Ulcer	– Ekuro
Skin rash due to allergy/ Urticaria	– Ερσ
Snoring	– Nkorσmohwa
Stroke / Paralysis	– Nnwodwoσ
Skin cancer	– Wedeε mu kokoram
Stomach ulcer	– Yamkuro

T

Tearing eye/ Watery eye	– Ani a εporo nsuo
Tetanus/ Tonic Seizure	– Asensene
Throat cancer	– Menemu kokoram
Toothache	– Kaka
Tooth decay/ Dental Caries	– Seporσeε
Tuberculosis	– Nsamanwa
Typhoid/ Severe Malaria	– Atiridinini

U

- Umbilical hernia – **Funumatu**
- Vomiting – **Ɛfee**

W

- Watery eye/
Tearing eye – **Ani a ɛporo nsuo**
- Whooping cough – **Nkɔnkɔn**
- Waist pain – **Sisiyaree**

SOME COMMON MEDICAL EXPRESSIONS
NYAWERA BI A EWƆ NNIPADUA AKWAA AHODOƆ MU

ENGLISH ➤ TWI

1. I have contracted mumps.
Agyemmirekutu aye me
2. I have a fever.
Me ho aye hye
3. I have a fever
Me ho aben
4. My leg is swollen.
Me nan ahono
5. My feet are swollen.
Me nan ase ataetae
6. Abdominal distention.
M'afuru ahye / ahono
7. My body itches.
Me ho ye me hene
8. I have a heart disease.
Meyare akomayare
9. I have nose bleeds/ Epistaxis.
Mepɔn ahwene
10. I have back pain/ache
M'akyi ye me ya.

11. I feel dizzy
M'ani so biri me.
12. I cannot see
M'ani nhunu adeε.
13. I am blind
M'ani afira.
14. I have foot rot
Aporɔporɔ ayε me.
15. I am suffering from diabetes
Meyare asikyireyareε.
16. My ear discharges
M'aso fiti.
17. I am anxious / panicky
Me yam hyehye me.
18. I get panic attacks
Ɛyε a na me yam ahye me.
19. I have constipation
Me yam atim.
20. I cannot pass stool / constipation
Mentumi nnya me nan.
21. I have diarrhoea/ running stomach
Me yam tu.
22. I have gonorrhoea
Babaso ayε me.
23. I have hepatitis/ liver disease
Mewɔ berεboɔ mu yareε.
24. I pass bloody urine
Medwonsɔ mogya.

25. I feel pain when passing urine.
Dwonsɔyaayaa ayɛ me.
26. I have jaundice
Meyare ebunu.
27. I have lip ulcer / sore
Ekuro ayɛ m'ano.
28. I have sore mouth
M'anom ayɛ kuro.
29. I am hypertensive
Meyare mogyaborosoo.
30. My child has convulsion
Esoro aka me ba yi.
31. My child has become stiff/ convulsion
Me ba no asensen.
32. My child has whooping cough
Me ba no bo nkɔnkɔn.
33. My child's ear discharges
Me ba no aso fiti.
34. My child is mad/ insane
Me ba yi abɔ dam.
35. My child has genital ulcers
Me ba no ase ayɛ kuro.
36. Startling attack
Me ba no bo birimbirim.
37. He/ she has convulsion
Wei aka no.
38. I have fit/ epilepsy
Metwa.
39. He/ she has fit
ɔtwa.

40. He/ she has fit/ epilepsy
Oyare etwere.
41. My head is splitting
Me ti pae me.
42. I have hydrocele
Etwo aye me.
43. I have scrotal swelling
Me hwoa aye kese.
44. I cough
Mebɔ wa.
45. There is a growth on my eye
Kooko asi m'ani so.
46. I have piles/ haemorrhoids
Kooko asi me to.
47. I am anaemic
Me mogya so ate.
48. I am bleeding
Mogya retu me.
49. I snore
Mehwa nkoromo.
50. I have hernia
Nkwee wɔ me so.
51. I have sore lips
Nwaahono agu me.
52. Boborygmi sound
Me yam bobɔ mu.
53. I have tuberculosis
Mebɔ nsamanwa.
54. He/ she is mad/ mental illness
N'adwene mu ka no.

55. She has breast cancer
Ɔyare nofoɔ mu kokoram.
56. Recurrent bleeding in pregnancy
Me nyinsen a na ɛso abubu.
57. He/she has Anthrax
Ɔyare nantwiyareɛ.
58. I have meningitis
Aso me tiri ne me kɔn.
59. I bleed from my nose
Meɔn ahwene.
60. I have miscarried
Mapɔn.
61. I am experiencing menstrual pain
M'anidane aba
62. I am pregnant
Me ho adane.
63. I am pregnant
Menyem.
64. I have vaginal itch
M'ase keka me.
65. Infertile male
Ne ho nsuo agyene.
66. I have lymph node swelling.
Dwoa atwe me /atwe me dwoa
67. No perception of foetal movement
Mente me ba ne nka/ Akwadaa no nka ne ho
68. He/she has rectal prolapse
Me ba no kɔkɔbo abɛtɛ ho.
69. I am breathless
Me home rete.

70. I have vaginal discharge
Nsuo regu me.
71. I feel pressed (I feel like passing stool-used by some women to indicate they feel pressure to pass stool in labour)
Afo de me.
72. I am irritable/ I feel uneasy
Me ho yera me.
73. I feel like pushing (used in labour to indicate an urge to bear a child)
Ebre me kyem.
74. I have burning sensation
Me ho dwane me/ me ho dwaa me.
75. I am weak
Maye hodwoo.
76. Insomnia
M'ani gu so saa.
77. Reference to sex/ When I have sex
Meko kwan so a...
78. I fell down
Mete tsee.
79. I collapsed/ I fainted
Metwa hwee.
80. I have Hiccups
Koterekoo asi me.
81. I feel pain in the throat when I swallow
Ntasuoakoram aye me.
82. I have sleep paralysis
Amuntum akye me.

N.B: Literally, “meko kwan so “ means to travel but we use it in reference to sex.

**AILMENTS ASSOCIATED WITH DIFFERENT
PARTS OF THE BODY**

NYAWERA BI A EWƆ NNIPADUA AKWAA AHODOƆ MU

ENGLISH >> TWI

1. HEADACHE – TIYAREḘ/ TIPAEḘ

My head aches	Me ti yḘ me ya.
Half of my head aches	Me ti fa yḘ me ya.
One sided headache	Me ti fa dwa me.
My scalp itches	Me ti mu keka me.
Throbbing/ Splitting headache	Me ti dwa me gagaga.
He/ She has mental illness	Ne ti mu ka no.
I have burning sensation in my head.	Me ti mu hyehye me.
My head aches	Me ti pae me.
I have burning sensation in my head	M'adwene mu hyehye me.
I have bad breath / halitosis	Me ti mu bɔn me.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Doctor: When did it start?
ḙhyḙḙ aseḙ dabɛn?

What treatment have you taken since it started?
ḙbae no aduro bɛn na woafa?

2. EYE – ANI

I have an eye problem/eye pain	M'ani yḘ me ya.
My eyes itch	M'ani so keka me/yḘ me hene.
My eyes are tearing	M'ani reporo nsuo.
I have discharge from my eyes	M'ani twa nkyene .
I have blurred vision	M'ani so y[me kusuu.
I feel dizzy	M'ani so biri me/kyini me.

My vision is blurred	M'ani so ayɛ me bisibisi.
Foreign body in the eye	Biribi atɔ m'ani so.
I cannot see clearly	Sɛ mehwɛ adeɛ a menhunu no yie.
Double vision / Diplopia	Mehunu adeɛ mmienu mmienu.
I cannot see far	Adeɛ wɔ akyiri a menhunu.
I cannot see objects close to me	Adeɛ bɛn me a menhunu.
I have an eye problem	Kooko ayɛ m'ani.
I have sty / chalazion	Dehyɛ asi m'ani so.
I have blurred vision	M'ani so yɛ me wantann.

3. EAR – ASO

I have ear ache	M'aso yɛ me ya.
My ear discharges	M'aso fiti.
My ear is itching/ itchy	M'aso mu keka me.
Noise in the ear / Tinnitus	M'aso mu yɛ me kyee.
Foreign body in my ear	Biribi akɔhyɛ m'aso mu.
My ears itches	M'aso mu yɛ me hene.

4. TEETH - ɛSE

I have sensitive tooth	Me se femfem me.
My tooth is aching/	
I have tooth ache	Me se yɛ me ya.
My tooth has become numb	Me se ayɛ titiritii
I have severe toothache	Me se tutu me.
I have a broken tooth	Me se so abu.

I have lost a tooth	Me se atu.
I have a hole in my tooth.	Tokuro abɛda me se mu
My gum bleeds	Me se akyi nam tu mogya
I want to replace my missing tooth	Mepɛ sɛ mesi me se
He/she drools	N'ano mae nsuo
I have toothache	Kaka ayɛ me se
I have bad breath/ Halitosis	Mekasa a na nka wɔ m'anum/M'anum bɔn
He/she has a cleft/split lip	N'ano apae
He/she has a cleft palate	Tokuro wɔ n'anom soro
I have stains on my teeth.	Me se so ayɛ fi
N.B: In Akan, “ɛse” is used for both tooth and teeth	

5. THROAT – MENEMU

My neck is aching	Me kɔn yɛ me ya
My throat is aching	Me mene mu yɛ me ya
I have a sore throat	Me mene mu ayɛ kuro
My throat is itchy	Me mene mukeka me
My throat is itchy	Me mene mu yɛ me hene
I have difficulty swallowing.	Mentumi mmene ntasuo
I have swallowed a fish bone	Kasɛɛ ahia me
He/She has swallowed a coin	Wamene sika
I have swallowed my artificial tooth	Mamene me se
Hoarseness/change of voice	Me nne asi/ Me nne afam/Me nne asesa
I cannot swallow saliva/ I have pains in the throat whens wallowing.	Ntasuoakoram ayɛ me

6. HAND – NSA

My hand aches	Me nsa yε me ya
My hand is injured/ broken	Me nsa mu abu
I have pain in my hand.	Mada me nsa so

7. SHOULDER – ABATIRE

My shoulder is dislocated/ twisted	M'abatiri ahwan/ afrikyiri
I have shoulder pain	M'abatiri yε me ya

8. BREAST – NOFOO

I feel pain in my breast	Me nofo yε me ya
There is a lump in my breast	Edwoa abeto me nofo mu
There is a lump in my breast	Biribi da me nofo mu
I feel pains in my breast when my baby suckles	Sε me ba no nom me nofo a, na εyε me ya
My breast has enlarged	Me nofo ayε kεse
I have breast cancer	Manya nofoo mu kokoram
I have discharge from my breast	Nsuo firi me nofo mu ba
My breast feels heavy	Me nofo mu yε me duru

9. CHEST PAIN – KOKO YADEE

I have chest pain	Me koko yε me ya
I have chest pain	Me bo yε me ya
I have Chest/ heart pain	M'akoma yε me ya

My heart beats fast/ palpitation M'akoma bɔ me paripari

I have chest pain Me mu yɛ me ya

I have waist pain/ I have
pain in my waist Me sisi yɛ me ya

I have low back pain Me pa yɛ me ya

I have pain in my
lower abdomen M'ayaase yɛ me ya

10. RIB – MFE

I feel pain in my rib Mpafe asi me

I feel pain in my rib Me mfe yɛ me ya

11. NAVEL – FUNUMA

I feel pain in my navel Me funuma mu yɛ me ya

I feel pain in the navel Me funuma mu keka me

There is sore in my navel Me funuma mu ayɛ kuro

12. ABDOMINAL PAINS – YAFUNU YADEɛ

I have abdominal pain Me yam tutu me

I have Abdominal Pain Me yam yɛ me ya

Borborygmi Me yam bobɔ mu /woro so

I have abdominal pain Me yam keka me

I have colicky abdominal pain Me yafunu ka me dwee

I have prickly abdominal pain Me yam wowɔ me

I feel some heaviness in
my abdomen Me yafunu ahyɛ kosoo

I feel bloated Me yafunu ahyɛ

Ailments associated with different parts of the body

I have abdominal discomfort	Me yam samforosamforo me
I have diarrhoea	Me yam hwie
I have diarrhoea	Megya me nan ntɛmntɛm
Something is moving in my abdomen	Biribi nenam me yam
My stool/flatus is offensive	Me yam bɔn
My flatus is offensive	Meyi mframa a ɛbɔn
My flatus is offensive	Meta a ɛbɔn

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Doctor: When did it start?
ɛhyɛ asee dabɛn?

How often? Mperɛ sɛn?

Is the stool mucoid or bloody?
ɛyɛ a ahɔɔ anaa mogya wɔ wɔ tiafi no mu?

13. BODY PAINS – AHOTUTUO

I have body pain	Me ho yɛ me ya
I have body ache	Me ho tutu me
I have rheumatism/Sickle cell disease	Me sasaborɔ aba/M'ahotutuo aba

14. LEG – NAN

My leg is aching	Me nan yɛ me ya
My leg is swollen	Me nan ahono

I have a dislocated/
twisted leg.

Me nan afrikyiri

My leg is injured/ broken

Me nan mu abu

I feel pain in my leg

Me nan mu tutu me

I have knee pain

Me kotodwe yε me ya

SEXUAL/ GYNAECOLOGICAL CONDITIONS
NNA MU YADEE

ENGLISH >> TWI



CONCERNING MEN

I feel pain in my penis/manhood when passing urine

Me dwonso a na me barima mu ye me ya.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Do you experience some discharge in your penis?

Eye a nsuo firi wo barima mu ba?

When was the last time you had sex?

Wo ne obaa dae nna sen nie?

Are you married?

Woaware?

Do you have any other sexual partner apart from your wife?

Wowo mpena?

Have you had any extra marital affair?

Wo ne obaa foro ada anaa?

N.B: In Akan, “me barima” - my manhood is used instead of my penis.

To say, “**me kote**” - my penis is a verbal taboo.

IMPOTENCE

I am impotent –

Me barima awu.

I don't have any erection –

Empagya/Me barima mpagya.

I cannot perform sexually –

Mentumi nko kwan so.

I am sexually weak –

Maye mmere wo mpam.

CONCERNING THE GENITAL ORGAN

I have hydrocele –

Etwo ayε me.

I have pain in my scrotum –

Me hwoa mu yε me ya.

I have an itchy scrotum –

Me hwoa ho yε me hene.

EXPRESSIONS WITH THE HIV/AIDS VIRUS

“Babaso” is used for gonorrhoea but following the advent of AIDS, a new Akan terminology/name has been devised for AIDS. Some people call it “Babaso werεmfoɔ” - the serious form/type of sexually transmitted disease. “Werεmfoɔ” is used when something is considered to be serious or deadly. Others qualify it as:

AIDS Babso werεmfoɔ - AIDS serious form of gonorrhoea

AIDS Kɔdiawuo - The deadly AIDS

Using the AIDS alone is understood by all speakers of Akan. They say;

Wanya AIDS - He has contracted the AIDS

Wakɔtete AIDS - He has contracted AIDS

Here again, no distinction is made between the HIV/AIDS. All the states are called AIDS.

Syphilis is called Babaso Kraman - Dog gonorrhoea. Dog is used to qualify it because of the way the male dog likes sex.

CONCERNING WOMEN

My vagina itches/ irritates

M'ase keka me/ M'ase yε me hene.

I have vaginal discharge

M'ase firi nsuo/Nsuo regu me

Offensive vaginal discharge

Nka wɔ m'ase/M'ase bɔn

I have vaginal ulceration

M'ase ayɛ kuro

I have vaginal pain

M'ase tutu me.

I have candidiasis/vaginal discharge

Manya odeepua

I am bleeding

Mogya retu me

I am in my menses

Mekɔ afikyire

I am in my menses

Mabu me nsa

I am in my menses

Mayɛ bra

I have not had my menses for two months now

Ɛbɛyɛ bosome mmienu nie menkɔɔ afikyire.

I am at menopause

Matwa bra

I feel pain in my lower abdomen

M'ayaase yɛ me ya

I feel a mass in my lower abdomen

Biribi abɛhyɛ/abɛfua m'ayaase

I feel a mass in my vagina

Biribi abɛhyɛ m'anan mu

I have blood in my urine.

Me dwonsɔ mogya

INTERACTION BETWEEN A DOCTOR AND A PATIENT

DOCTOR

When did it start?

Ἐχθῦε ἀσεε δαβεν?

PATIENT I

It started on Monday

Ἐχθῦε ἀσεε ἔδwoada no

It started two days ago

Nnanu ne nne na Ἐχθῦε ἀσεε

It started three days ago

Nnansa ne nne

It started four days ago

Nnenan ne nne

It started five days ago

Nnanum ne nne

It started six days ago

Nnansia ne nne

It started a week ago

Nnawɔtwe nie

It started some days ago

Ἐnnaanoo na Ἐχθῦε ἀσεε

It started two weeks ago

Nnawɔtwe mmienu nie

It started a week ago

Dapen nie na Ἐχθῦε ἀσεε

It started yesterday

Ἐnora

It started today

Ἐne

PATIENT II

It started in January

᾽pɛpɔn bosome mu

A month after Christmas

Buronya akyi bosome baako

A month ago

Bosome nie

Two months ago

Bosome mmienu nie

Three months ago

Bosome mmiensa nie

A year now

Afe nie

Two years ago

Mfee mmienu nie

Three years ago

Mfee mmiensa nie

GENERAL AILMENTS, FEVER AND COUGH

ENGLISH >> TWI



THE PEDIATRIC EMERGENCY UNIT

It is a unit that looks after the general ailments of children. These are some of the interactions patients have with doctors:

My child has difficulty in breathing

Me ba no home a εnsi so.

My child is wheezing/difficulty in breathing

Me ba no tee so.

My child is grunting

Me ba no pene.

My child has fast breathing

Me ba no home ntemntem.

My child has startling attacks

Me ba no bɔ birimbirim.

N.B: In Akan, “me ba” is referred to both masculine and feminine ward unless it is qualified by “me babarima” - my male ward or “me babaa” - my female ward.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS

Is he/she asthmatic? Ɔwo ntehyeewa?

When did it start? Ehyee aseε dabɛn?

How old is he/she? Wadi mfee sɛn/ Wadi sɛn?

He/she is a month old? Wadi bosome.

He/she is one year old? Wadi afe.

My child has convulsion Esoro aka me ba no.

My child has convulsion Wei aka me ba no.

FOLLOW UP QUESTIONS.

Doc: How does he/she behave when it happens?

– **Se ɛba a sɛn na ɔye?**

Parent: He/she becomes stiff – **ɔsensene.**

The body shakes – **Ne ho woso.**

Doc: Does he/she foam?

– **N'ano pu/twa ahuro?**

Parent: Yes – **Aane.**

No – **Daabi.**

Doc: How often?

– **Mpen dodoɔ sɛn na yareɛ no ba?**

Parent: Once a week – **Nnawɔtwe biara ɛba.**

Once a month – **Bosome biara ɛba.**

This is the first time – **Yei ne deɛ ɛdi kan.**

Doc: What did you do when it happened?

– **ɛbaɛ no, ɛdeɛn na woyɛɛ?**

Parent: I dropped some juice from onion into his/her eyes

– **Me posaa gyeene de sɔɔ n'ani so.**

I poured some water on him/her

– **Mebɔɔ no nsuo.**

N.B: In the Akan society, instead of a parent mentioning that the child has convulsion, she would rather say “wei” - (This) aka no - (has affected him/her).

“Wei aka no” is accompanied by pointing the right hand at the universe because convulsion “soro” literally meaning “the universe” is considered a verbal taboo in the ethnography of speaking in this respect. It is believed that if the expression: “ɛsoro aka me ba no” is used, the sickness will be increased hence the use of “wei” .

FEVER DESCRIPTIONS

1. My temperature rises sometimes
Ɛye a na me ho aye hye.
2. I have fever
Me ho aye hye
3. I feel weak
Me ho ye me hodwoo.
4. I have easy fatigability
Me nante kakra bi a na mabre.
5. I have joint pain
M'apɔso m'apɔso ye me ya.
6. I have lost appetite
M'anom ato.
7. I cannot eat much
Mentumi nnidi kese.
8. I have headache
Me ti ye me ya.
9. I have runny nose
Me hwene mu firi nsuo.
10. I vomit/ throw up
Ɛye a mefe/ Mefe.
11. I vomit or throw up after eating
Aduane ka m'ano a na mafe.
12. I have cold/catarrh
Manya kataa
13. I have cold
Manya papuu.

14. I have fever/ Jaundice
Manya yarefufuo/ebunu
15. I feel nauseous
Me bo fono me.
16. I spit a lot
Metete ntasuo.
17. I have heartburn
Me bo hyehye me.
18. I have insomnia
Mentumi nna.
19. I am feeling feverish
Mafoee.

COUGH – ƆWA

20. I cough
Mebo wa.
21. He/She coughs
Ɔbo wa.
22. I have haemoptysis
Mebo wa a na mpya wo mu.
23. He/She has whooping cough
Ɔbo nkɔnkɔn
24. I have tuberculosis
Mebo nsamanwa

MONTHS ON THE YEAR - BOSOME A ƐWO AFE MU

TWI

ENGLISH

January	Ɔpɛpɔn
February	Ɔgyefuo
March	Obenim
April	Oforisuo
May	Kotonimma
June	Ayɛwohomumɔ
July	Kitawonsa
August	Ɔsanaa
September	Ɛbo
October	Ahinime
November	Obubuo
December	Ɔpɛnema

DAYS OF THE WEEK - NNA A ƐWO NNAWƆTWE MU

TWI

ENGLISH

Monday	Ɛdwoada
Tuesday	Ɛbenada
Wednesday	Wukuada
Thursday	Yawoada
Friday	Efiada
Saturday	Memeneda
Sunday	Kwasiada

INDEX

A

Abdomen 55, 82, 83, 88
Abdominal 62, 82
Abscess 63
Acne 68
Aids 62, 87
Anaemia 62
Anaemic 74
Anasarca 62
Anthrax 75
Anumkuro 69
Anxiety 67
Anxious 72
Appetite 93
Arc 56
Armpit 55
Asthma 62
Attacks 72, 91

B

Baby 81
Baby suckles 81
Back 56, 62
Backache 62
Barreness 62
Bedwetting 62
Bleeding 62, 65
Blind 72
Blindness 62
Bloated 82
Blocked nose 63

Bloody urine 62
Blurred vision 62, 78
Body swelling 62
Boil 63
Bone cancer 63
Breast 55, 58, 63
Breast cancer 63
Breath 65
Breathless 75
Broken 79, 81, 84
Burning sensation 76, 78
Buttocks 56

C

Calf 56
Cancer 63, 67, 68, 69, 75, 81
Cancer 63
Candidiasis 63
Cataract 67
Catarrh 63, 93
Chalazion 63, 69
Cheek 55, 58
Chest 58, 68, 81
Chest pain 68
Chicken pox 63
Chin 55, 58
Cholera 63
Christmas 89
Chronic ulcer 63
Cold 63, 65
Cold sore 63, 65

Collapsed 76
Common cold 63
Constipation 63, 72
Convulsion 63
Cough 63

D

Dandruff 64
Deafness 64
Decay 64, 69
Dental 64, 69
Dental caries 64, 69
Diabetes 64, 72
Diarrhoea 62, 64, 68, 72, 83
Diplopia 79
Discharge 63, 64, 76, 78, 81, 86, 88
Discomfort 83
Disorders 62
Dizziness 64
Doctor 78, 83, 89
Double vision 79
Drools 80
Dumbness 64
Dysentery 62, 64
Dysuria 67

E

Ear 55, 58, 64
Ear discharge 64
Ear discharges 72, 73, 79
Ectopic 64
Elbow 55, 58
Elephantiasis 64
Epistaxis 62, 71

Erection 86
Eye 69, 70, 74, 78, 79
Eyebrow 55, 58
Eye lid 55
Eye pain 78
Eyes 55

F

Fainted 76
Feel uneasy 76
Female 62, 91
Fever 64, 65, 66, 71, 94
Fingers 55, 58
Fits 64
Flatus 83
Foot 56, 58, 65
Foot rot 65, 72
Fore head 55
Foreign 79
Foreign body 79
Foreign body in the eye 79
Foul breath 65
Fungal Nail Infection 65

G

General body pains 65
Genital ulcers 73
Growth 74
Grunting 91
Guinea worm 65

H

Haematuria 62
Haemoptysis 94

Haemorrhage 65
 Haemorrhoids 68
 Hair 55, 58, 65
 Halitosis 65, 78, 80
 Hand 55, 58
 Head 55, 58
 Headache 65, 78, 93
 Heartburn 94
 Heart disease 71
 Heat rash 65
 Hepatitis 65, 72
 Hepatitis/ liver **disease** 72
 Herpes labialis 63, 65
 Hiccups 76
 High temperature 64, 65
 HIV 62, 87
 HIV/AIDS 87
 Hole in **heart** 66
 Hunger 66
 Hypertension 66
 Hypertensive 73
 Hypoglycaemia 66

I

Illness 74, 78
 Impotence 66
 Impotent 86
 Infection 65
 Injured 81, 84
 Insane 73
 Insomnia 76
 Intestinal disease 66
 Irritation 66

Itch 75, 78
 Itches 71, 78, 79, 87
 Itching 66, 79

J

January 89
 Jaundice 66, 94

K

Kidney disease 66
 Knee 56
 Knees 66

L

Leprosy 66
 Liver 65, 67, 72
 Liver cancer 67
 Liver disease 65, 72
 Lump 67, 81
 Lymph node **swelling** 67

M

Mad 73, 74
 Mad/ insane 73
 Madness 67
 Malaria 67, 69
 Marital affair 86
 Married 86
 May 76, 86, 88
 Measles 67
 Menopause 88
 Menses 88
 Menstrual disorder 67
 Menstrual pain 67, 75

Index

Mental illness 74, 78

Migraine 67

Miscarriage 67

Month 89, 91, 92

Mouth 55, 58

Mucoid 62, 64, 83

Mumps 67

N

Nails 56

Nasal congestion 63

Nausea 67

Nauseous 94

Navel 58, 82

Neck 55, 58

Newborn 64

Nipple 55

Node swelling 67, 75

Non-healing ulcer 63

Nose 55, 58, 62, 63, 68, 71, 75, 93

Numb 79

P

Pain 62, 67, 68, 70, 71, 73, 75, 76, 78, 81, 82, 83, 84, 86, 87, 88, 93

Pains 65, 80, 81

Palm 55, 56, 58

Palpitation 82

Panic 67

Panicky 72

Paralysis 76

Paralysis 68, 69

Paronychia 65

Penis 58, 86

Perineal 68

Piles 68

Pimples 68

Pityriasis vesicolor 68

Polio 68

Pregnancy 64, 75

Prolapse 75

Pushing 76

R

Rabies 68

Rash 65, 68, 69

Rectal prolapse 68, 75

Rheumatism 68, 83

Rib 55

Ringworm 68

Running nose 68

Runny nose 93

S

Scalp 68, 78

Scalp itches 78

Scrotum 87

Seizure 69

Sensitive tooth 79

Severe malaria 69

Sex 76, 86, 87

Sexually Transmitted Disease (STD) 87

Sexual partner 86

Shingles 68

Shoulder 55, 58

Skin cancer 69

Snoring 69

Sore 63, 65, 67, 73, 74, 80, 82

Split lip 80

Splitting 74, 78

Start 78, 83, 89, 91

Startling attack 73

Stomach 55, 58, 69

Stomach ulcer 69

Stroke 69

Stye 63, 69

Sunday 95

Swallowing 68, 80

Swelling 67

Syphilis 69

T

Tearing eye 69, 70

Temperature 65

Tetanus 69

Thigh 55

Throat 68, 69, 76, 80

Throat cancer 69

Throw up 93

Tinea capitis 68

Tinnitus 79

Toe 56

Toe nails 56

Tonic seizure 69

Tooth 64, 69, 79, 80

Toothache 69, 79, 80

Tooth decay 64, 69

Treatment 78

Tuberculosis 69, 74, 94

Twisted 81

Typhoid 69

U

Ulcer 63, 69

Ulcers 73

Urine 62, 72, 73, 86, 88

Urticaria 69

V

Vagina 55

Vaginal discharge 63

Vaginal itch 75

Vesicolor 68

Vision 62, 78, 79

Vomit 93

Vomiting 70

W

Waist 55, 58, 70

Weak 76, 86, 93

Week 89, 92

Whooping cough 70, 73, 94

Wife 86

Y

Year 89, 91

